

DESARAE MCNAIR

PRODUCT EXPERIENCE
DESIGNER

CONTACT

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WEBSITES:

- LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/alkendria-mcnaair](https://www.linkedin.com/in/alkendria-mcnaair)
- GitHub: github.com/DesaraeMcnaair
- Portfolio: desaraemcnaair1.github.io

SKILLS

- **UX/Product:** UX/UI Design • HCI • User Research • User Flows • Wireframing • Prototyping • Usability • Accessibility • Requirements • MVP Planning
- **Technical:** Python • SQL • C++ • Machine Learning • AWS • Azure • Cybersecurity • IBM Z • COBOL • Git
- **Tools:** Figma • Figma Make • Excel

LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND CERTIFICATIONS

- **IBM Z Student Ambassador** | Technical outreach, events, and student engagement
- **Vice President & Founding Member, LSAMP** | Student recruitment, STEM programming, and organizational development.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

M.S. Computer Science + B.S. Cybersecurity professional combining UX/HCI, product design, and technical engineering to create intuitive digital experiences. Experienced in user-centered design, prototyping, AI/ML, cybersecurity, and translating complex problems into technology solutions.

EDUCATION

December 2025
Master of Science (M.S.) in Computer Science
University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

December 2023
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Cyber Security
University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

EXPERIENCE

September 2026 - Present
Adjunct Instructor
University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Design and deliver undergraduate instruction in **Mainframe Systems and COBOL**, translating complex enterprise computing concepts into practical learning experiences.
- Develop technical course materials, assessments, and hands-on activities aligned with learning objectives.

July 2024 - Present
Academic Advisor
University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Manage an advising portfolio of **572+ undergraduate students**, using student performance and engagement data to identify needs and develop individualized success strategies.
- Collaborate with faculty, administrators, and support services to resolve complex issues and improve student outcomes.
- Identify process and communication gaps and connect students with resources that support retention and degree completion.

January 2024 - December 2025
Research Assistant
University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- **U.S. Army, Motor Transport Operator** | 2013–2016
- **IBM Product Management Professional Certificate** — In Progress, Expected Dec. 2026

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Neuro Adapt AI — AI Product Strategy | UX/UI | AI/ML

Designed an AI-powered adaptive learning product that personalizes educational experiences based on user behavior, learning patterns, and preferences. Translated product requirements into user flows, interface designs, and a high-fidelity interactive prototype.

Student Job Connect — Product Strategy | UX/UI | User Research

Designed a two-sided student employment platform connecting students with flexible, degree-relevant opportunities. Defined user needs, personas, workflows, and MVP features while designing experiences for both students and employers.

Advising Hub — Product Experience | HCI | Technical UX

Designed a centralized academic advising platform based on the needs of 572+ undergraduate students. Applied HCI and UX principles to improve information architecture, academic planning workflows, communication, and student-facing experiences.

- Developed machine learning models to analyze network traffic and identify **IoT cybersecurity anomalies**.
- Evaluated data patterns and refined algorithms to improve detection accuracy and model performance.
- Presented technical findings and translated research results into actionable recommendations.

January 2023 - December 2023

Equipment Specialist

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Managed technical equipment projects from initiation through completion while coordinating requests, deliverables, and multiple stakeholders.
- Provided technical troubleshooting and support for hardware and software systems.